. Abul Fazl calls him ‘Nannu’, but this undignified diminutive cannot reduce the tragic heroism of the uncrowned prince. Muzaffar Shah, last of the Muzaffarid dynasty, used as a pawn by various Gujarati nobles, was arrested during Akbar’s first conquest of Gujarat in 1572. He managed to escape in 1578 and had raised enough support to pose a serious challenge to the government in Gujarat five years later. Abdur Rahim’s suppression of Muzaffar Shah’s uprising in 1583–84 is what gained him his father Bairam’s title, khan-khanan. Muzaffar Shah, meanwhile, continued to battle for his father’s throne for the next decade – a Jesuit mission travelling through Gujarat would note the ravages of war, ‘towns and large cities which were mostly in a state of ruin, particularly the mosques, which had not been rebuilt’ (Fr. Pierre Du Jarric, *Akbar and the Jesuits: An Account of the Jesuit Missions to the Court of Akbar*, trans. C.H. Payne [First published 1926; Low Price Publications, 2008]). Eventually, in the winter of 1592, Muzaffar Shah was betrayed by one of his allies and arrested by the Mughals. As he was being escorted to court, the prince asked to relieve himself. Muzaffar covered himself with a canopy and took out a razor. He carried the blade with him at all times, knowing he would die before he gave up his fight. The fight was over now, the empire had prevailed. Muzaffar Shah ‘Gujarati’ put the blade to his own throat and ended his life (Abul Fazl, Badauni and Ferishta all tell versions of this story).

. Michael H. Fisher, *A Short History of the Mughal Empire* (I.B. Tauris, 2016).

. Abu’l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 6, trans. W.M. Thackston (Murty Classical Library of India, Harvard University Press, 2020).

.Abdul Qadir Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh* (Selections from Histories), vol. 2, trans. W.H. Lowe (first published 1884–98; Atlantic Publishers and Distributors, 1990).

. ‘The Happy Sayings of His Majesty’, in Abu’l Fazl, *The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 3, trans. Col. H.S. Jarrett (First published 1927; Low Price Publications, 2014). Abul Fazl writes that the duty of kings is to emulate how the sun sheds its light upon the world and makes life possible. He follows this with a pitying aside on the ‘weak-minded zealots who, with much concern, talk of His Majesty’s religion as of a deification of the Sun, and the introduction of fire-worship[.] But I shall dismiss them with a smile.’ See Abu’l Fazl, *The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 1, trans. H. Blochmann (First published 1927; Low Price Publications, 2014).

. Abu’l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 6, trans. W.M. Thackston.

.Annemarie Schimmel, *The Empire of the Great Mughals: History, Art and Culture* (Reaktion Books, 2004, reprinted in 2010).

. It was the conquest of Gujarat and access to its ports that allowed the women to make the pilgrimage. Characteristically, Akbar expanded the scope of their journey to include the less privileged of his subjects – according to Nizamuddin, all ‘pious poor’ who wanted to join Gulbadan were given the means to. In fact, Nizamuddin writes that Akbar created the post of a Mir Haji to conduct annual state-sponsored pilgrimages to Mecca. ‘Never before had any monarch provided for the annual departure of a caravan from India,’ he writes, ‘nor had any one furnished means to the needy, to enable them to perform the pilgrimage.’ See Nizamuddin Ahmad, ‘Tabakat-i Akbari’, in *The History of India, As Told by Its Own Historians*, trans. H.M. Elliot, vol. 5 (Trübner and Co., 1873).

Ironically, and perhaps because these expeditions were so well endowed, Mughal pilgrims were not very popular with Mecca’s government. Its ‘Ottoman governors,’ writes Michael Fisher, ‘reported that Mughal visitors distributed so much charity as to disrupt the local economy, remained too long, did not respect Ottoman sovereignty, and were spying for a joint Mughal–Portuguese invasion of Yemen.’ See Fisher, *A Short History of the Mughal Empire*.

. Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe.

. There is one Mughal history, the *Iqbalnama*, that tells a slightly different story. In this version, Abdun Nabi was put in Abul Fazl’s charge, who had the judge strangled, thus slaking an old thirst